



The Karakoram Range

The greatest concentration of high mountains in the world

Spanning the northern regions of Pakistan and India, with parts in China and Tajikistan, the Karakoram lies to the northwest of the Himalayas and contains nearly all of the world's 100 highest peaks that are not in the Himalayas (see pp.222–23). These include the world's second highest mountain, K2, which rises to a height of 28,251 ft (8,611 m).

Climbing challenges

The Karakoram Range is about 310 miles (500 km) in length and is heavily glaciated. Some individual glaciers, such as the Baltoro (see p.233), are among the world's longest glaciers outside the polar regions. The Karakoram is sparsely populated, and visitors are almost exclusively intent on scaling one or more of its peaks, some of which are extremely difficult to climb. They include K2 and the Trango Towers, a group of granite columns situated close to the Baltoro Glacier.

About **1 in 5** people who have **tried to climb K2** have **died** in the attempt

△ NAMELESS TOWER

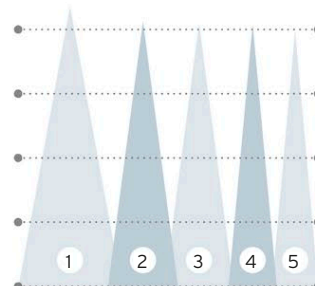
Called the Nameless Tower, the granite peak at the center here is part of the Trango Towers. Its near-vertical sides rise some 2,950 ft (900 m) above the ridgeline, and the spire reaches up to 20,469 ft (6,239 m).

▷ SAVAGE MOUNTAIN

Seen here with a serac (pointed block of glacial ice) in the foreground, K2, also called Mount Godwin-Austen, is known as the Savage Mountain because of the extreme difficulty of its ascent.



HIGH PEAKS OF THE KARAKORAM



- 1 K2 28,251 ft (8,611 m)
- 2 Gasherbrum I 26,509 ft (8,080 m)
- 3 Broad Peak 26,414 ft (8,051 m)
- 4 Gasherbrum II 26,362 ft (8,035 m)
- 5 Gasherbrum III 26,089 ft (7,952 m)